INCH-POUND

MIL-T-43271C
10 December 1991
SUPERSEDING
MIL-T-43271B
3 June 1977

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TRAY, MESS, COMPARTMENTED, PLASTIC

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.2 Scope. This specification covers requirements for a 5-compartment plastic mess tray.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

P-D-1800	-	Dishwashing Compound, Machine (Granular, Bead or Flake)
UU-P-553	-	Paper, Wrapping, Tissue
PPP-B-636	-	Box, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5018 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 7350

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY

MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification for

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-595 - Colors Used in Government Procurement

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-731 - Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

DRAWING

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT, AND ENGINEERING CENTER

5-13-1748 - Tableware, Plastic: Tray, Mess, 5-Compartment

(Copies of drawings are available from the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: STRNC-UX, Natick, MA 01760-5017.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION AND WELFARE

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

21 CFR 121: Subpart F - Food Additives Resulting From Contact with Containers or Equipment and Food Additives Otherwise Affecting Food

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-9325.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 256	-	Test Methods for Impact Resistance of Plastics and Electrical Insulating Materials
D 523	-	Gloss, Specular
D 790	-	Test Methods for Flexural Properties of Unreinforced and Reinforced Plastics
D 3951	-	Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.3) in accordance with 4.3.

3.2 Color. The color of the trays shall be tan or pastel green, as specified (see 6.2). The pastel green colored trays shall conform to FED-STD-595, within the range of color numbers 24525, 24504, and 24533. The tan colored trays shall conform to FED-STD-595, within the range of color numbers 20450, 21643, 22563, and 23531.

3.3 Material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of this specification.

3.3.1 Molding compound. Molding compound used for manufacturing the trays shall be a melamine formaldehyde resin modified with not more than 18 percent phenol and shall contain a chopped cotton cloth filler. The compound shall have a uniform composition, with the resin and filler thoroughly mixed, and shall be free of foreign matter such as dirt and metal particles. In addition, the molding compound and any substance incorporated in the plastic shall conform to the applicable requirement of section 121 under subpart F of U.S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare, Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act for contact with food.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.1.1 Izod impact strength, flexural strength, and deflection at rupture. Molded specimens, when tested as described in 4.5.1, shall meet the minimum requirements (minimum on any sample) shown in table I.

TABLE I. Minimum requirements

Izod impact strength	Flexural strength (flatwise)	Deflection at rupture
Foot-pound per inch of notch	P.S.I	Inch
1.0 ft. lb/in	11,000	0.087

3.4 Construction, design, and dimensions. Trays shall be molded from compound specified in 3.3.1 in accordance with the requirements specified herein and in the design and dimensions shown on Drawing 5-13-1748.

3.5 Finish. The surfaces of the trays shall have a uniform luster throughout, equal to or higher than the approved first article, produced by molding techniques, by burnishing, or otherwise treating the base material and not by the application of a finish or protective coating such as lacquer or by the use of other adulterants. After removal of flash, trays shall be burnished.

3.6 Uniformity. All trays shall be uniform in texture and finish, and uniform in color and shade within the allowable variations of standard color numbers specified in 3.2. Blemishes or discoloration which do not affect the ability of the tray to be sanitized or the overall appearance of the trays are permitted.

3.7 Marking for identification. Each tray shall be permanently and distinctly marked by an embossed molded-in process with the letters "US", the manufacturer's name, trade name, or trademark of such known character as to be easily identified with the manufacturer, and the year of manufacture. Markings shall be placed on the outside bottom of the tray in the center of the large compartment and shall occupy an area of not more than 1 square inch. The markings shall be raised by intaglio engraving, be approximately 0.007 inch in height and the face of the markings shall be flush with the surface of the bottom of the tray.

3.8 Resistance to boiling detergent. Trays shall show no cracks, chalking, appreciable fading or change of color (see 6.7), or any other defects impairing the serviceability or appearance when tested with boiling detergent as specified in 4.5.2.

3.9 Resistance to boiling sulfuric acid. Each test specimen shall show no signs of chalking, and have an initial gloss value of not less than 80 and a final gloss value of not less than 60, when tested as specified in 4.5.3.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.10 Odor. Trays shall have no objectional odor, and when tested as specified in 4.5.4 shall not develop an objectionable odor.

3.11 Warpage. A loaded tray as specified in 4.5.5, shall not exceed 0.125 inches at the center point on each long side and 0.025 inches at one tray corner.

3.12 Stoving. Trays shall show no cracks, blisters, appreciable fading of color, loss of luster, or any defects impairing serviceability or appearance when tested as specified in 4.5.6.

3.13 Surface hardness. The entire upper surface of the tray shall be treated to achieve a surface hardness capable of withstanding the test specified in 4.5.7.

3.14 Resistance to disinfection. When tested as specified in 4.5.8, the tray shall not evidence any loss of gloss or change in color.

3.15 Workmanship. The finished trays shall be flash-free, clean of oil, dirt, chips, and free from defects resulting from molding, finishing, or contamination. The end item shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification and the occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.1.2 Certificates of compliance. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to inspect such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 3.1 and 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.1, 4.4.2, and 4.4.3 and shall be tested for the characteristics specified in 4.5. The presence of any defect or failure to pass any test shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of reference documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document. In addition, the molding compound shall be tested for the characteristics listed in table II. The sample unit shall be as specified in 4.5.1 and shall be molded from the same lot of molding compound from which the trays were manufactured. Test bars shall be appropriately identified. The sample size (number of sample units to be tested) shall be 5 for the size bar designated for the flexural and deflection tests. There shall be no failure of any sample unit to meet the requirements as specified in table II.

TABLE II. Component and material tests

Characteristics	Requirement paragraph	Test Method	Number of determinations per sample unit	Results reported as pass or fail
Molding compound	3.3.1	Certificate of compliance		
Resistance to impact	3.3.1.1	4.5.1	1	X
Flexural strength	3.3.1.1	4.5.1	1	X
Deflection at rupture	3.3.1.1	4.5.1	1	X

4.4.2 End item visual examination. The end items shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in units of

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

trays. The sample unit shall be one tray. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

TABLE III. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Major	Minor
Tray	Scuffed, abraded, or rough area	101	
	Dent	102	
	Crack or fracture	103	
	Wrinkle	104	
	Unfilled area	105	
	Chipped	106	
	Checked	107	
	Scratch		201
	Chalking		202
	Pinhole		203
	Blister		204
	Pit		205
	Flow mark		206
	Presence of oil or grease, dirt, wood shaving, metal chips, or other foreign matter on tray surface		207
Luster	Not uniform high luster throughout		208
Color	Not specified color	108	
	Lack of uniformity of color and shade		209
	Shade of color does not fall within the range of color numbers specified (see 3.2)		210
Texture and finish	Presence of any finishing coating	109	
	Lack of uniformity in texture and finish (see 6.9)	110	
Construction and	Varies from design and shape shown on applicable design drawing	111	
Material	Presence of molded-in particles of metal, cured resin, flash, dirt or other materials	112	
	Any blemish or discoloration which affects overall appearance	113	
Corners and edges	Sharp		211
	Flash not removed	114	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE III. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Major	Minor
Surfaces and curves	Not blended smoothly		212
Identification marking	Not permanently marked by an embossed molding process	115	
	Required marking missing, incorrect, or illegible	116	
	Any data omitted	117	
	Not located as specified	118	
	Covers an area more than 1 square inch		213

4.4.3 End item dimensional examination. The end items shall be examined for conformance to the dimensions specified on the drawing. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of trays. The sample unit shall be one tray. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

4.4.4 End item testing. The end items shall be tested for the characteristics listed in table IV. The lot size shall be expressed in units of seven trays. The sample unit shall be seven trays, one tray for each test characteristic. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

TABLE IV. End item tests

Characteristics	Requirement paragraph	Test method	Number of Determinations per sample unit	Results reported as pass or fail
Resistance to boiling detergent	3.8	4.5.2	1	X
Resistance to boiling sulfuric acid	3.9	4.5.3	1	X
Odor	3.10	4.5.4	1	X
Warpage	3.11	4.5.5	1	X
Stoving	3.12	4.5.6	1	X
Surface hardness	3.13	4.5.7	1	X
Resistance to disinfection	3.14	4.5.8	1	X

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.5 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete sealing or closure of flap, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling Bulged or distorted container
Content	Number per container is more or less than required

4.4.6 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load, fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified Load not bonded as specified Interlocking of loads not as specified
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

4.5 Methods of inspection.

4.5.1 Impact strength, flexural strength and deflection at rupture. Impact strength shall be determined by testing in accordance with ASTM D 256, using a 1/2 by 1/2 by 2-1/2 inch bar as the sample unit. Flexure strength and deflection at rupture shall be determined by testing in accordance with ASTM D 790 using a 1/4 by 1/2 by 5 inch bar as the sample unit for each characteristic.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.2 Resistance to boiling detergent. The tray shall be completely immersed for 1 hour in a boiling 0.3 percent solution of detergent conforming to type I of P-D-1800. Distilled water shall be used to make the solution. The level of detergent solution shall be maintained throughout the test period. At the expiration of the 1 hour period, the tray shall be removed and rinsed in clear hot water and allowed to air dry. After drying, the tray shall be examined for presence of any of the defects in 3.8.

4.5.3 Resistance to boiling sulfuric acid. Test specimens, each measuring 4 inches (± 1/4 inch) square shall be cut from the four corner sections and from the center portion of the tray. A gloss meter shall be used to measure the luster rating of the specimens in accordance with ASTM D 523, using guidelines for 85 degree beam axis angles. Each test specimen shall have an initial gloss value of no less than 80. Specimens with an initial gloss value of not less than 80 shall be immersed for 10 minutes in a boiling solution of sulfuric acid 0.8 percent by weight, then rinsed in cold water and dried. After drying, a final gloss value shall be taken in accordance with ASTM D 523. Any specimen with an initial gloss value of less than 80, or final gloss value of less than 60, or any visible signs of chalking, shall cause failure of the test (see 3.9). The examination for chalking and the test for the luster rating shall not include any area 1/4 inch or less from any cut (not molded) edge.

4.5.4 Odor. The tray shall be half-filled with boiling distilled water. A plate of glass shall be immediately placed over the rim of the tray and weighted down to obtain good contact between rim and glass. After 5 minutes the plate of glass shall be removed and the presence or absence of odor shall be determined immediately (see 3.10).

4.5.5 Warpage. Warpage shall be determined by placing the tray in the normal use or serving position on a flat surface. The tray shall be firmly held in place by means of a 10 pound weight extending from rim to rim and positioned at the center of the tray parallel to the short length. In this position, when measured by use of a feeler gauge at each corner of the tray, each of three compartment bottoms shall make positive contact with the flat surface, and meet the requirements of 3.11.

4.5.6 Stoving. Place the tray in a circulating air oven for 8 hours at 170°F ± 2°F. The tray shall then be removed, placed in the position of use on a table, and allowed to cool normally to room temperature and examined for presence of any of the defects in 3.12.

4.5.7 Surface hardness.

4.5.7.1 Apparatus.

a. Surface hardness tester of the design developed by the National Bureau of Standards for testing the resistance of the surface of plates to knife cutting or scratching (see 6.4).

b. Stainless steel table knife.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.7.2 Specimen. The specimen shall be a minimum of 2-1/4 x 2-1/4 inches square, cut from the meat compartment (largest compartment) of the tray.

4.5.7.3 Procedure. Sharpen the blade of the knife, being certain to wipe the blade with a clean cloth. This is to remove grit or abrasive particles resulting from the sharpening. Clamp the handle of the knife tightly in the holder after locating the tip on the crosswise centerline of the specimen with the holder midway off its stroke. The knife should be in an angle of approximately 30°, and when in operation should be moved back and forth across the centerline of the specimen. Clamp a 3 pound weight on the blade so that its center of mass is directly above the point of contact of the knife with the surface of the specimen. The specimen shall be washed with soap and water, then rinsed with hot water and allowed to air dry on edge. Center the specimen on the turntable. Apply 10 drops of peanut oil to the surface of the specimen, spreading it over the entire test area with a soft cleansing tissue. Slowly lower the knife onto the surface with the blade in the forward limit of the stroke, being careful to avoid abrupt contact of the blade with the test surface. Subject the specimen to 20 cycles of 100 strokes each. After each 100 strokes, resharpen, clean, and reposition the knife blade; clean test surface; and relubricate with oil. After the completion of the last cycle, examine the test surface. Any evidence of deterioration or visible scratches on the upper surface of the test specimen shall be reported as a failure.

4.5.8 Resistance to disinfection. The tray shall be immersed in a disinfectant of calcium hypochlorite at room temperature for 1 hour. The solution shall be prepared by dissolving 360 milligrams of calcium hypochlorite in 1 liter of tap water. This corresponds to a 250 parts per million of available chlorine. The tray shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.14.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A packing. Twenty-four trays shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The trays shall be nested flat, 24 deep within a shipping container. A 15 by 12 inch sheet of tissue paper conforming to type I, class 1 or 2 of UU-P-553 shall be placed between each tray and the top and bottom of each stack of trays. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 14-1/2 inches in length by 11 inches in width by 7-1/4 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method V and reinforced as specified in the appendix of the container specification. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.2). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.2 Level B packing. Twenty-four trays shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The trays shall be nested flat, 24 deep within a shipping container. A 15 by 12 inch sheet of tissue paper conforming to type I, class 1 or 2 of UU-P-553, shall be placed between each tray and the top and bottom of each stack of trays. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 14-1/2 inches in length by 11 inches in width by 7-1/4 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only.Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

5.1.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the fiberboard shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

5.1.3 Commercial packing. Trays shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), trays, packed as specified in 5.1.2 or 5.1.3 shall be palletized on a four-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet types shall be type I (four-way entry), type IV, or type V, in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Pallets shall be fabricated from wood groups I, II, III, or IV of MIL-STD-731. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means C and D or film bonding means F or G. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. Trays covered by this specification are intended for use in the field, standard service mess halls, Navy shipboard, and in post, camp, and station hospitals.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. Color required (see 3.2 and 3.2.1).
d. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

e. Level packing (see 5.1).
f. Type and class of unit load required (see 5.1.1).
g. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.1.2.1).
h. When palletization is required (see 5.2).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 52.209. The first article should be preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Apparatus. The NBS tester specified in 4.5.7.1 may be obtained from either of the following:

A.J. Wahl, Inc.
Brocton, NY 14716

Halsey, Inc.
Scranton, PA 18509

6.5 Dispensing information. When trays are automatically dispensed the following information is furnished:

Height of one tray	- 1-1/8 inch
Weight of one tray	- 1 lb. 7 oz.
Height of eleven trays	- 3-1/2 inches
Weight of ten trays	- 14 lbs. 6 oz.

6.6 Information service. A more detailed description of the NBS tester and method of operation may be obtained from the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5018.

6.7 Change of color. Appreciable fading or change of color is defined as one which is immediately perceptible in comparing the tested specimen with the original comparison specimen. If closer examination or a change in angle of light is required to make apparent a slight change in color, the change is not considered appreciable.

6.8 Texture. Texture may be considered as referring to the fine detail of structure.

6.9 Subject term (key word) listing.

Dish
Divided
Individual server
Melamine dishes

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.10 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 99

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MS
Air Force - 50, 84

User activities:

Navy - MC

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project 7350-0253

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER MIL-T-43271C	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 1991 December 10

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
TRAY, MESS, COMPARTMENTED, PLASTIC

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (*Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.*)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)
	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code)
J.S. Army Natick RD&E Center	(1) Commercial: 508-651-4085 (2) AUTOVON: 256-4085
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Commander, U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center ATTN: STRNC-WEE Natick, MA 01760-5018	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20240-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currenversion before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:03Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.